

In my use, the Nord 5 barely breaks a sweat. It opens apps in a snap, handles multitasking like a pro, and doesn't show signs of memory pressure even when juggling heavy apps like Google Maps, Instagram, and WhatsApp side-by-side. I experienced no stutter when opening YouTube PiP + Chrome + camera. The LPDDR5X RAM and UFS 3.1 storage combo keeps things fluid, even with resource-hungry tasks like Lightroom editing or rapid file transfers.

Where the Nord 5 really flexes is stability under pressure; the 84% throttle score beats the Nord 4's 77% and stays comfortably behind the Poco F7's 90%, but unlike some other devices that only hit their peak in short bursts, the Nord 5 feels consistently fast.

On the software side, OxygenOS 15 on Android 15 remains a highlight. It's clean, smooth, and bloat-free aside from a few removable pre-installs. Animations are fluid, transitions are slick, and OnePlus's 4+6 year update promise is the kind of long-term support that should be standard but isn't.

Then there's the new Plus Key, OnePlus's answer to productivity hardware. Instead of the traditional alert slider, you now get a customizable AI shortcut that lets you quickly summon Plus Mind, save screen content, or access AI Search and other on-device smart features, including Gemini.

BATTERY LIFE

The OnePlus Nord 5 doesn't just up its performance game; it brings serious stamina to match that. It packs a 6,800mAh battery, the largest ever seen in a Nord device, and it shows.

In our PCMark Work 3.0 battery test, the Nord 5 clocked an impressive 15 hours and 35 minutes, and my usage mirrors this: even with a heavy mix of social media, camera use, GPS, and YouTube, the phone comfortably powers through a full day and then some.

Charging isn't the fastest in its class, but it's no slouch. The bundled 80W adapter takes the Nord 5 from 0 to 100% in around 55–60 minutes, which is respectable given the battery size.



It's not quite as blistering as the 100W charging seen on the Nord 4, but in exchange, you're getting longer endurance and smarter power management.

The Nord 5 brings Bypass Charging into the mix. When gaming, it intelligently routes power directly to the chipset instead of pushing it through the battery, keeping thermals in check and extending battery health. There's also OnePlus' Battery Health Engine, which helps retain 80% battery capacity even after four years of daily charging.

Overall, the Nord 5's battery life is less about speed-demon charging and more about practical reliability. It's built to last, not just for the day, but for years.

CAMERAS

The OnePlus Nord 5 is easily the most ambitious Nord camera setup yet and it delivers a refined and dependable camera experience, which is particularly impressive for a phone in its price category. Its strength lies in the main sensor's consistency, the versatility of its digital zoom, and its colour science, which holds up pretty well across diverse lighting scenarios.

- **Main (rear):** 50MP Sony LYT-700, f/1.8, 1/1.56" sensor, 1.0µm pixels, Triple-axis OIS
- **Ultra-wide (rear):** 8MP, f/2.2, 1/4" sensor, 116° FoV, EIS
- **Front:** 50MP Samsung ISOCELL JN5, f/2.0, 1/2.75" sensor, 0.64µm pixels, 90° FoV, EIS

In daylight, the main 24mm f/1.8 wide camera consistently produces sharp, well-exposed images with accurate colours and pleasing contrast. Photos like the subject on the tree trunk demonstrate excellent surface-level detail, and fine rendering of textures in foliage, bark, and architecture. The dynamic range is commendable, too, and preserves highlight detail in skies while pulling out shadows from under tree canopies and shaded structures.

In short, the Nord 5 camera focuses on doing the essentials well. It offers strong daylight performance, a dependable main sensor, a surprisingly effective digital zoom, and decent portraits.

—Siddharth Chauhan

SPECIFICATIONS

Display: 6.83-inch 1.5K OLED panel with 144Hz refresh rate | SoC: Snapdragon 8s Gen 3 | RAM: 8GB | Storage: 256GB | OS: OxygenOS 15.0 based on Android 15 | Camera: 50MP main camera Sony IMX906 + 8MP ultra-wide + 50MP front camera | Battery: 6800mAh, 80W fast charging | Weight: 211g | Other: Type-C port, Wi-Fi 6, Bluetooth 5.4

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